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Dell XPS 13 9310

Still the benchmark in the 13-inch ultrabook category

Dell has been pushing the boundaries in the laptop space with its XPS lineup for many years now. Almost all the previous notebooks in the XPS series have received raving reviews from us and other enthusiasts. Is the latest Dell XPS 13 9310 the best 13-inch Ultrabook on the market? Let's find out in our full review.

DESIGN AND BUILD QUALITY

The Dell XPS series has some of the most beautiful machines in this ultra-portable laptop space, and the Dell XPS 13 9310 is no exception. Thanks to the bevelled edges, the laptop looks elegant from the sides even when it's closed.

As you open the lid, you will be greeted with that stunning display and the woven glass fibre keyboard deck.

The Dell XPS 13 comes with dual 2.5W stereo speakers located at the lower edge. Despite the not-so-ideal placement, they get quite loud and output clear audio.

KEYPAD, TRACKPAD AND IO

Ever since Dell decided to switch to a new keyboard on the XPS machines, it's been a fantastic experience to use them for typing. They have adequate travel and feel nice to touch.

The trackpad on the Dell XPS 13 9310 is also great. There's not a lot of room to work with since the chassis just doesn't allow that, but the experience of using it is quite satisfying.

Moving on to the IO, you only get 2 Thunderbolt 4 ports. There's also a microSD card reader on this variant along with a 3.5mm headphone jack.

DISPLAY

The unit which we got for review came with a 13.4-inch 4K UHD+ panel. It's Dell's InfinityEdge touch display with



500 nits brightness. After running the standard set of tests, we were quite surprised by its performance. Colour Volume analysis tells us that this display covers 100% of the sRGB and 81% of DCI-P3 colour space. That's very much in line with what Dell's claims about the display. The display also has a contrast ratio of 1546:1 which is again pretty good.

It's also a very colour accurate display with a peak luminance of 481 cd/m². The black luminance was recorded at 0.311 cd/m², which is amongst the lowest we have seen.

This means that it's a great panel for consuming any kind of content. It's also a really good display for content creators, although the accompanying hardware might keep you from heavy photo and video editing tasks.

PERFORMANCE

The Dell XPS 13 9310 is powered by the 11th Gen Intel Core i7-1185G7 CPU. It also comes with an EVO badge so you can expect it to be snappy when it comes to the day-to-day workloads including its boot times.

We ran the usual set of benchmarks on this laptop. Starting off with PCMark 10, the laptop managed to score 4755 which is slightly above the average score. On Cinebench R20, the laptop managed to score 1405 points. It performs better than the last year's

Dell XPS 13 which was powered by the Intel Core i7-1065G7. Moving on to the GPU, the laptop is fitted with the Intel Iris Xe graphics. In 3DMark's suite of application tests, the Dell XPS 13 ended up scoring big numbers to outperform some of the other thin and laptops we have tested here at Digit. Despite not having a discrete GPU, gaming isn't completely out of the picture here. However, we don't recommend playing intense AAA titles on this laptop.

BATTERY

All the Dell XPS 13 9310 variants pack a 53Whr battery.

In PCMark 10's Modern Office test, the Dell XPS 13 managed to last just over 8 hours. Lowering the brightness further will yield you more hours and it can even hit upwards of 13 hours on the same test.

In real-world usage, you should be able to get about 6-7 hours of usage at about 75% brightness.

VERDICT

The Dell XPS 13 9310 continues to remain one of the best 13-inch Ultrabook that money can buy. The newer variant benefits from the new 11th Gen Core processor. It's a discernable performance improvement and adds more value to the already great ultrabook. The battery life is still a hit or miss, but that's not an issue that is exclusive to the XPS 13. You get a spectacular display, impressive build quality, good keyboard & trackpad, and more which makes this laptop a no brainer in the 13-inch ultrabook category.

—Karthik Iyer

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-1185G7 quad-core processor with a base clock of 3.0GHz and a turbo frequency of 4.8GHz | GRAPHICS: Intel Iris Xe Graphics, 96EUs | RAM: 16GB LPDDR4 2133MHz | STORAGE: 1TB PCIe GEN3 x4 NVMe SSD | DISPLAY: 13.40-inch UHD+ 16:10 display with touchscreen support. Dell SDC414F display with HDR and 60Hz support

CONTACT

DELL | PHONE: Web form | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.dell.com/en-in>